

05 / 05 DELIVERABLE · THE INSTRUMENT

When-to-Hire Instrument

Not a headcount calculator. A when-to-hire router — it tells you when strain in the analyst function means *hire*, versus *automate*, *redesign*, or *fix the knowledge base*. This is Michele's instrument.

Status Capacity feed live · report feed builds as tracking fills in **Owner** Michele Curran, COO

Live now [Open the capacity checker ↗](#)

Today the hiring call is gut. This turns *"I feel like we need someone"* into *"here's the trend line, here's the threshold we crossed, here's why it's a hire and not a tool."* Defensible upward, built in peacetime, on purpose.

“Metrics in place before we trigger hiring.”

MICHELE CURRAN, FRAMING THE BRIEF

One router, two feeds

FEED 1 · CAPACITY

Daily 3-tap check-in — perceived load, why, and who's working what. Live today.



THE WHEN-TO-HIRE ROUTER

Automate → Redesign →
Fix knowledge base →
Hire, walked in that order, always.



FEED 2 · DELIVERY

Per-report facts — cycle time, on-cadence rate, rework rounds. Ships with Deliverable 1.

Two feeds because they capture different things at different natural moments. Capacity captures how the team *feels*, daily — three questions, no more, so the response rate stays protected. Delivery facts crystallize once, at the moment a report actually ships. Neither is a second job; both ride along on work that was happening anyway.

The five signals — one glance, like the dashboard

LOAD TODAY

6.5/10

How loaded everyone feels, daily — the earliest warning

CAPACITY

CLIENTS IN FLIGHT

4/person

Active work per analyst — the "full hands" ceiling

CAPACITY

CYCLE TIME

9 days

Start to delivered — climbs weeks before a deadline slips

REPORTS

ON-TIME RATE

84%

Reports delivered by their due date

REPORTS

REVISION ROUNDS

1.7/report

Your #1 named pain — usually a knowledge base gap, not headcount

REPORTS

Numbers above are illustrative — the real ones come from your own data. Five signals, not twenty: a COO should read this in 30 seconds or the instrument is wrong. Every threshold is Michele's to tune as real data comes in.

The when-to-hire router — four questions, in order

A 1990s tool asks "slammed → hire?" This asks four questions in order. Hire is the last answer, never the first reflex — because every earlier stop is cheaper and faster than a new salary.

1 · AUTOMATE IT?

Is the strain a repetitive, rules-based task? Then automate it — don't hire for it.

→

2 · FIX THE WORKFLOW?

Does the slowdown cluster at one handoff or client? Then fix that step, not the headcount.

→

3 · FIX THE KNOWLEDGE BASE?

Is quality the issue because a standard lives in someone's head? Then write it down, once.

→

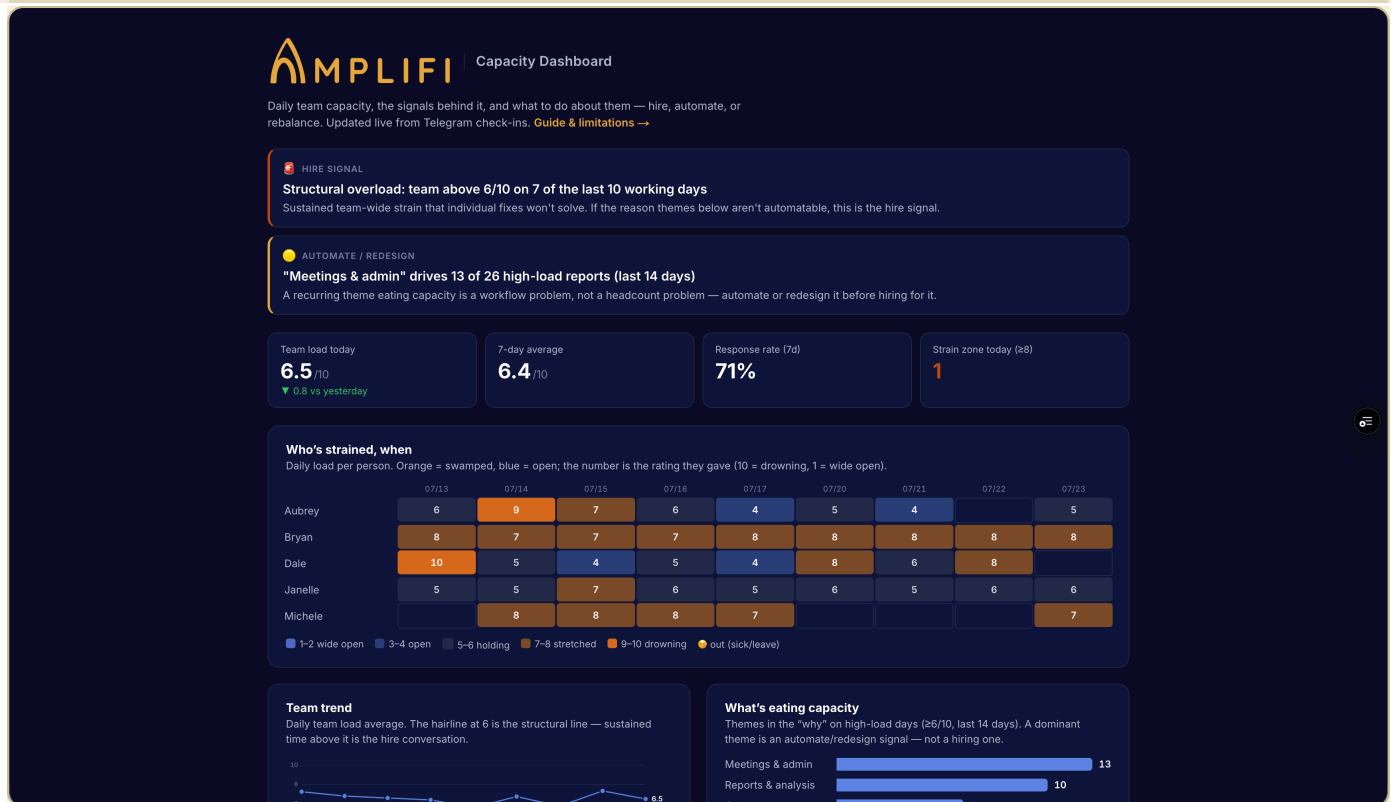
4 · HIRE

Only when 1–3 are ruled out across the whole team, with enough data to trust the read. That's the defensible hire.

The output is never "hire: yes/no." It's "here's what crossed, here's why the answer is this route, here's the evidence trail."

What's live today

The capacity checker is live — daily check-ins from the team, Michele's morning summary, the dashboard. The report-level view is next, and once the whole thing is proven it moves to Amplifi's own domain and accounts, with a step-by-step migration guide — it was always yours to keep.



The when-to-hire reading itself is usable *by hand*, right now — it doesn't wait on any dashboard code. Michele and Chii walk it monthly with the dashboard and the report tracking open side by side, the moment each has a few weeks of data.

What Michele sees

Daily, live today: a 10:00 summary — team average, everyone's load and reason, sorted most-loaded first, flags for anyone over the line.

Anytime, live today: the dashboard — tiles, trend, and plain-language signal detail.

Monthly, live today, by hand: the full router line — *"Rework on Client X crossed threshold in week 6 → routes to a knowledge base fix, not a hire."* Fifteen minutes to write, thirty seconds to read, defensible in one line.

Once the dashboard build lands (60–90 days): the same line, generated automatically instead of hand-assembled. Convenience, not new capability — the capability is already there.

Baselines & calibration

Thresholds can't be known upfront — v1 sets them, reality sharpens them. That's said plainly on purpose; it's the method, not a weakness. Trust is gated on *completed cycles*, not calendar time, because a weekly client and a monthly client reach a trustworthy baseline at very different speeds:

CADENCE	TIME TO A TRUSTWORTHY BASELINE
Weekly	~3 weeks (3 completed cycles)
Bi-weekly	~6 weeks
Monthly	~3 months

Until a client crosses its own bar, its numbers are read qualitatively alongside broader patterns rather than trusted in isolation. Every threshold recalibrates quarterly with Michele against real distributions — living numbers, not one-time settings.

Hard rules

Owned and portable. Signal data lives in your knowledge base and an exportable database — no vendor lock on the data itself.

Runs on the stack already in use. Drive, Telegram, the tools your team already touches.

Five signals, not twenty. Readable in 30 seconds, or it's wrong.

A router, not a binary. Never a bare hire/no-hire — always the evidence trail behind it.

Feeding it is never a second job. Three taps a day, one row opened per scheduled cycle, updated at ship, finalized at acceptance. That's the entire cost.

Why this matters above Michele's desk, too

When the hire moment comes, the ask that goes upward isn't "we're slammed, we need someone." It's a trend line, the threshold it crossed, and the cheaper options already tried and ruled out — automation checked, workflow checked, knowledge

base checked. That's a decision a CEO can approve in one read, because the homework is attached. Data carries the ask; the gut just started the conversation.

The lines to hold

Hire is the last resort on the router, not the first reflex.

This tells you why it's a hire, not just that it's a hire — that's what you defend upward.

The knowledge base is yours. The AI is rented.

v1 sets baselines. Reality sharpens the thresholds.

Chiibitsu Labs — more human, by design.